

Karan Hotwani

Senior Backend Engineer | Node.js | GraphQL | AWS | PostgreSQL

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SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with 6+ years building high-throughput distributed systems for B2B SaaS and fintech products. Deep expertise in Node.js, Fastify, GraphQL, and PostgreSQL with a strong track record of architecting scalable microservices from the ground up, optimizing data pipelines, and delivering reliable systems at scale. Experienced in mentoring engineers and leading backend architecture decisions across cross-functional teams. Available for remote contract engagements with international and Indian companies.

SKILLS

Backend: Node.js, TypeScript, Fastify, NestJS, Express, Hasura, GraphQL, REST APIs, Microservices

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, Firebase, NoSQL, Elasticsearch

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (SQS, Glue, S3, Athena), Docker, SigNoz, Monitoring and Observability

Integrations: Pub/Sub, SMTP, Payment Gateways (Xendit, Boost, Seedflex), HTML to PDF, Third-party APIs

Frontend: React.js, API Integration

Soft Skills: System Design, Mentoring, Cross-functional Collaboration, Agile, Scrum, CI/CD

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer

Food Market Hub | Pune, MH | Mar 2022 - Present

- **Architected** a scalable **microservices** backend from scratch using **Node.js**, **Fastify**, **GraphQL**, and **PostgreSQL** - scaled to **200+ B2B customers** with **99.9% uptime** while handling **3x traffic growth** without degradation.
- Built a high-throughput **transactional email service** delivering **10M+ emails** with robust retry mechanisms, structured logging, and **SQS**-based autoscaling architecture.
- Engineered a **document generation pipeline** (HTML to PDF) producing **5M+ PDFs/month** - handling complex templating, rendering performance, and guaranteed output reliability at scale.
- Integrated multiple **payment systems** (Xendit, Boost, Seedflex Pay Later) ensuring secure, low-latency transactions across the platform.
- **Optimized** critical **PostgreSQL** queries and refactored core services, improving overall system efficiency by **30%**.
- Designed **analytics pipelines** using **AWS Glue**, **S3**, and **Athena** - reducing data export times by **98%** and enabling near-real-time reporting.
- Maintained secure **REST and GraphQL APIs** with layered auth and **RBAC** - enabling seamless integration across web, mobile, and third-party clients.
- **Mentored** junior engineers and established backend engineering standards across the team.

Junior Backend Developer

Easeyourlife | Mumbai, MH | Jul 2019 - Feb 2022

- Built and scaled **RESTful APIs** and database models using **Node.js**, **Express**, and **Firebase** - supporting high-traffic user flows in a fast-paced startup environment.
- Integrated **payment gateways** and third-party services end-to-end; independently owned backend infrastructure for critical user-facing flows.
- Delivered features across **Firebase**, **NoSQL**, **Dialogflow**, and **GraphQL** - often sole backend engineer on projects with direct founder collaboration.
- Implemented **unit testing** and monitoring to improve system reliability and reduce production incidents.
- Translated business requirements into **production-ready features**, consistently meeting delivery timelines in an agile environment.

OPEN SOURCE

mail-jack - Self-hostable HTTP Email Service

github.com/KaranHotwani/mail-jack | Go, AWS SES, PostgreSQL, Docker | Personal Project

- Built a production-grade self-hostable email HTTP service in Go with AWS SES, per-recipient open and click tracking, PostgreSQL audit logs, Docker support, and API key authentication.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology

VES Institute of Technology, Mumbai University | Mumbai, MH | Jun 2019

- CGPA: 7.8 / 10